Whisper is a boundary, not a destination.

The pipeline I built to turn rambling voice notes into work that survives Monday morning.

10 slides · swipe

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Transcription is where the work starts.

Raw transcripts are graveyards of half-sentences. The real job is turning speech into decisions, tasks and links a system can use.

Words are the raw material.
Structure is the product.

The flow, end to end.

01 Audio lands via Syncthing / Telegram

↓

02 Whisper transcribes — small on CPU, larger on GPU

↓

03 Cleanup: hallucination filter, segment dedup, speakers

↓

04 LLM summarizes into decisions / tasks / links

↓

05 Note lands in Obsidian as clean markdown

Self-hosted end to end. No cloud audio roulette.

What actually makes a note useful.

01 Speaker separation — me vs the other voices

02 Decisions pulled out explicitly

03 Tasks extracted with owners, not vibes

04 Links and file references preserved

05 Uncertainty marked — never smoothed over

A perfect transcript of nonsense teaches nobody anything.

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The silent hallucinations.

Whisper confidently invents words in noise. Generic filler, wrong names, invented numbers — fluent and wrong. My fix: average_logprob and compression_ratio gates per segment.

**If it's fluent AND wrong,
it's worse than silence.**

The two numbers that catch the lies.

```
$ segment = whisper(...)

if segment.avg_logprob < -1.0: drop

if compression_ratio(segment) > 2.4: drop

# fluent repeated junk never reaches the note
```

Cheap gates, ruthless results.

Where a person still belongs.

The pipeline flags, marks uncertainty and organizes. A human reads the note and pulls the thread — especially for decisions nobody else was there to hear.

Machines pre-digest.
Humans decide.

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Two ways to use voice notes.

COMMON

Record and forget

files accumulate
never re-read
zero action

WORKING

Speech to system

transcription → tasks
decisions → docs
links → repo

Same microphone. Wildly different outcome.

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What this unlocked for me.

Drive-time meetings become searchable decision logs. Brain dumps become task lists by morning. The vault is the teammate that never forgets the agreement.

Say it once.
Never lose it again.

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VOICE NOTES · KEEP THIS · 10/10

Save this for your next audio workflow.

If your voice notes die in a downloads folder, the bottleneck isn't transcription — it's the missing step after it. Build that first.

Save for later review

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